

The four checkboxes listed under “List Views” allow you to select which columns of information you want to see in the list views (“By Name,” “By Date,” “By Size,” and “By Kind”). If you don’t often care when a file was last modified, for instance, you can turn that column off by clicking the “Show date” checkbox.

The “Show disk info in header” also affects list views. Usually list views have *two* lines of header information. The first line tells you the disk’s type (ProDOS, HFS, etc.), the number of files in the window, and how much space is used and available on the disk. The second line provides labels for the columns. If you’d rather see more files and less disk information, turn off this checkbox and the first line will disappear. (Icon views always show the disk info.)

“Save Finder information onto disk” controls whether or not the Finder saves the locations, sizes, and views of your windows and the positions and colors of your icons. The Finder saves this information in hidden files known as Finder.Data files—one in every window you’ve ever opened in the Finder. If you’d rather not have the Finder leaving its droppings all over your disks, turn this checkbox off. Any Finder.Data files the Finder has already saved will remain.

Note!

You can override this feature temporarily by holding down the Control key while you close a window. The Finder won’t save the data for that window. (If the Finder has previously saved the information in this folder, it will not be updated—the next time you open the folder, any changes you made to the appearance of the window will be gone.) The Control key forces the Finder to do the opposite of the Preferences setting—if you turn “Save Finder info” off, holding down the Control key when you close a window will cause it to be saved.

By The Way...

If you hold down Control while you open a folder or disk, the Finder will ignore any information it’s already saved for that window and display it at the default location with the default size (the view will be set to “By Icon.”)

If you’d like to be able to see Finder information files and other normally hidden files, turn the “Hide invisible files” checkbox off. (Turn off “Save Finder info” and “Hide invisible files,” to seek out and destroy Finder info files without recreating them as quickly as you delete them.)

By The Way...

The Finder saves information in the following files: Finder.Data (position of windows and icons), Finder.Root (position of icons moved to the desktop), and Finder.Def (preferences).

If you uncheck “When starting up, check 5.25” drives,” the Finder will display only the 5.25” drive icon, and won’t try to read the disk. You’ll have to double-click the drive icon to make the Finder look in the drive. If you have 5.25” drives but rarely use them, you can uncheck this box to avoid the nasty grinding sound the Finder makes when it checks empty drives.

If you uncheck “Color selected icon’s background instead of its outline,” the Finder’s Color menu will color an icon’s outline instead of filling it with color. (You normally get this effect by holding down the Control key when you choose a color; changing this preference *reverses* the function of the Control key when choosing colors.)